The Life You *Choose*

FREE EXERCISE · FROM STEP 1 OF THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT

An ordinary *Tuesday*.

Describe what you want to change, what you want to keep, and one small step you could take to find something out. This also works for a change you can make where you already live. Take a pen and a quiet moment.

WARM-UP

Moments that felt good

Think of one or two moments from the last few years when you felt content, engaged, or proud. Choose at least one from an ordinary day. Where were you? What were you doing? Who was with you? What made it possible?

A normal day in the life you want

Now you turn those ingredients into a day.

We use an ordinary day because most of your life will be ordinary. It can feel less exciting than imagining a big change, but it gives you a useful question: would I enjoy the everyday life that comes with it?

An ordinary day also gives you something to test. You can visit a place, or change one day of your week where you live, and try living a normal Tuesday. It is much harder to test a word like "happiness".

Is a whole day too much for now? Start with one moment in your week you would like to change.

How much detail? Enough that someone else could film it. Look at the difference:

Too vague to plan	Detailed enough to plan
"A house with a view"	"Coffee on the terrace, looking at olive trees, before anyone else is awake"
"Meaningful work"	"Two mornings a week helping new business owners solve problems I understand"
"Close to family"	"My sister can come for dinner without booking a flight"

The detail in the right-hand column gives you something you can check against a real house, job or town.

NOW YOU

Describe this day from morning to evening. Include an ordinary detail you would not put in a holiday brochure: housework, rain, or an hour when nothing much happens. Use these questions to help you:

- Where do you wake up? What do you see from your window?
- What do you do in the morning? And in the afternoon?
- What is your work, or how do you spend your time?
- Who is with you? How does the day end?

> **Made-up example 1 (Maria, 46), moving:** I wake up at 7, without an alarm. From my window, I see olive trees. I drink coffee outside. In the morning, I work online for my clients for four hours. In the afternoon, I work in the garden or go to the market. Two afternoons a week are for paperwork and cleaning, and I don't enjoy them. I go to bed tired, but happy.

> **Made-up example 2 (Jeroen, 52), staying:** I work full-time and help my mother every Wednesday. That stays, and my income must stay the same. On an ordinary Tuesday, I now spend an hour and a half in the car. I want one morning a week without travel time, with coffee at the kitchen table and a calm start. My small test: I ask my manager whether I can work from home on Thursdays for four weeks. I ask nothing about hours or salary. If that is not possible, I try to travel outside rush hour one morning a week.

THE NEED BEHIND THE PICTURE

Olive trees might mean calm, nature, or space. What two or three needs does your ordinary day meet? Could you meet the same needs another way, perhaps closer to home?

Some ideas may come from lives you have seen online. Write them down too. Later, you can ask which parts actually matter to you.

FROM PICTURE TO STEP

From this picture to one small step

What do I want to keep from my current life?	
Which question do I want to look into first?	
What makes starting hard right now?	*You can pick more than one:* ☐ I don't yet know what I want ☐ I don't know if it will work ☐ I can't afford or arrange it right now ☐ Other things come first right now ☐ Something else
My small test is:	
I start on:	
I look back on:	
If this does not work, then:	

A test can also show that you should stay, try something else, or wait for now.

What is a small test? A test does not have to be a trip, a cost, or a big decision. It can be a conversation, looking up one reliable source, or a small trial of a few days.

If no workable step fits your life right now, waiting is also fine. Write down what would need to change and pick a date to look again. That date does not mean the problem will be gone by then.

What comes next

This exercise is one part of Step 1, Picture. In the full step, you compare your options in more depth, research them, do an initial money check, and write down your decision.

Phase 1 of The Made Real Blueprint (Steps 1 to 3) is available as self-study, with workbooks and an app, all in plain English. See the options at **maderealblueprint.com**.

Questions about the exercise? Message me on WhatsApp or email **info@maderealblueprint.com**.
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